

Sleepy Shores

A Fishing Sim Game

GAME DESIGN/TECHNICAL DOCUMENT

Created in 2023 - Finished 2024



Get swept away in the serenity art of fishing..

Summary

This document contains game design documentation for Sleepy Shores, a project created and developed by Cert 3 students at the Academy of Interactive Entertainment (or AIE) and is a game based around the wonderful world of fishing.



Game Overview

At-A-Glance Overview

Official Name	Sleepy Shores
Genre	Casual, Adventure, Creature Collector, RPG-ish(?), Family Friendly, Fishing Sim
Theme	Cozy, Relaxing,
Camera Perspective	Isometric, Overhead Third Person View, Static Position
Game Engine	Unity
Type	2D+2.5D Mixed
Age Rating	9+
Platforms	PC

Players	Single-Player
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High Concept Statement

Get swept away by the relaxing ocean waves, soft gentle breeze and oddly calming smell of the fish by the seaside. Here, your only troubles are how you're gonna catch that fish you've been dreaming about all day...and your lingering financial troubles.

Game Description

Sleepy Shores is a single-player, cosy 2.5D Isometric overworld fishing simulator game, set in the waters surrounding an isolated island town. Your job as the player is to explore the ocean waters, and find, catch, and sell fish in order to achieve your fishing goals for both yourself, and your fellow fish neighbours.

Pillars

Inventory Management

Replayability

Relaxation



Story

Story Synopsis

It's Johnny's 18th birthday, so, as a special gift for his "coming of age" Johnny's old man, Papa, has decided it's time for him to start his very own fishing journey- a passed down tradition in Papa's family, and gives Johnny his very own fishing rod & boat, so he too can follow in the footsteps of his ancestors... and make his Papa proud.

Setting

Sleepy Shores is set in the early 90s when technology and smart phone devices were not as present in people's day to day lives. "Sleepy Shores" is the name of the island
Serenity Ocean Ambience

Characters



PLAYER

Name: *Johnny*

Age: 18

Description: *Johnny is an optimistic, driven, caring and sometimes cheeky young man with short ginger hair, green eyes like his father, rosy cheeks and likes to carry a big ol cheeky grin on his face wherever he goes. He is the son of and has a very close bond to Papa.*

Role In-Game: *Johnny is the character the player embodies, and explores the game as. The player gets to choose what Johnny decides to do and where he decides to go, and will decide Johnny's fate at the end of the game.*



NPC

Name: *Papa*

Age: 51

Role In-Game: The tutorial figure and guide through the ins and outs of the game



NPC

Name: *Merchant*

Age: 25

Role In-Game: The shopkeep through which you sell fish and buy upgrades

Story Outline

Introduction

- ❖ Introductory Cutscene
- ❖ Tutorial in the form of helpful Text Prompts as the Player plays the game

Gameplay

- ❖ Catch fish, Sell Fish, Upgrade gear to catch better fish, Repeat

Endgame

- ❖ Finally fulfil your dream of leaving the island for something more exciting (Meh Ending)
- ❖ Collect all Fish and make Papa proud (Good Ending)



Gameplay

Win State/s

The player's main objectives in Sleepy Shores is to:

- ❖ *Catch and sell enough fish to earn 10,000 gold coins*
- ❖ *Complete all 20 quest tasks*

A special long-term objective they can aim to complete is to:

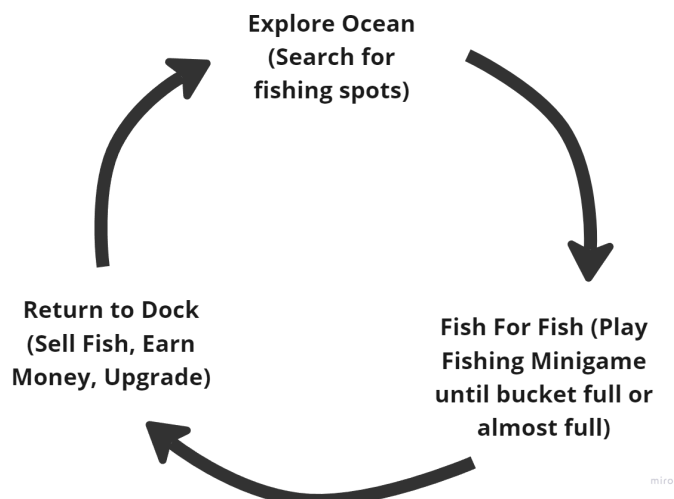
- ❖ *Completely fill out the Fishituary by catching all 20 species of fish*

Player Controls/HotKeys

Gameplay Controls	Function
Left Click	Use UI Buttons/Interact
WASD Keys	Move Boat/Move Fishing Line in Minigame
Hold Spacebar and Release	Cast Fishing Rod
Esc	Open Pause Menu/Close UI Menus

Enter Key (To be changed to E)	Interact
I Key	Open/Close Inventory
F Key	Open/Close Fish Book
R Key	Replay Minigame

Core Gameplay Loop



1. Explore Ocean

- ❖ Move around the ocean terrain within your boat's current ocean boundaries
- ❖ Search for a fishing spot

2. Fish for Fish

- ❖ Fishing minigame opens
- ❖ Cast Rod into ocean
- ❖ Move fishing line in ocean to try and catch a fish
- ❖ Catch a fish and reel it back to the surface OR miss a catch and try again
- ❖ Add fish caught to bucket stash
- ❖ REPEAT until bucket is close to/is full OR player chooses to leave minigame

3. Return to Dock

- ❖ Move boat into dock area
- ❖ Open up merchant's shop
- ❖ Sell fish to merchant, earn money

❖ *Spend money earned on boat, rod or bait upgrades OR choose to save the money*

Gameplay Features

Ocean Exploration

Explore all the island's ocean waters has to offer in your very own boat, and seek out new ocean areas and fishing hotspots.

Fishing Minigame

Cast and manoeuvre your fishing line in the ocean waters, and potentially hook a fish to reel back to your boat.

Fulfilling Island Town Folk's Quests

Complete quest tasks given to you

Shop Merchant

Sell fish you catch and use money you earn to upgrade your fishing gear.

Upgrade Bait to lure in rarer fish

Upgrade your Fishing Rod to make it quicker and easier to catch harder fish

Upgrade your Boat to explore further out into the ocean and increase your inventory limit

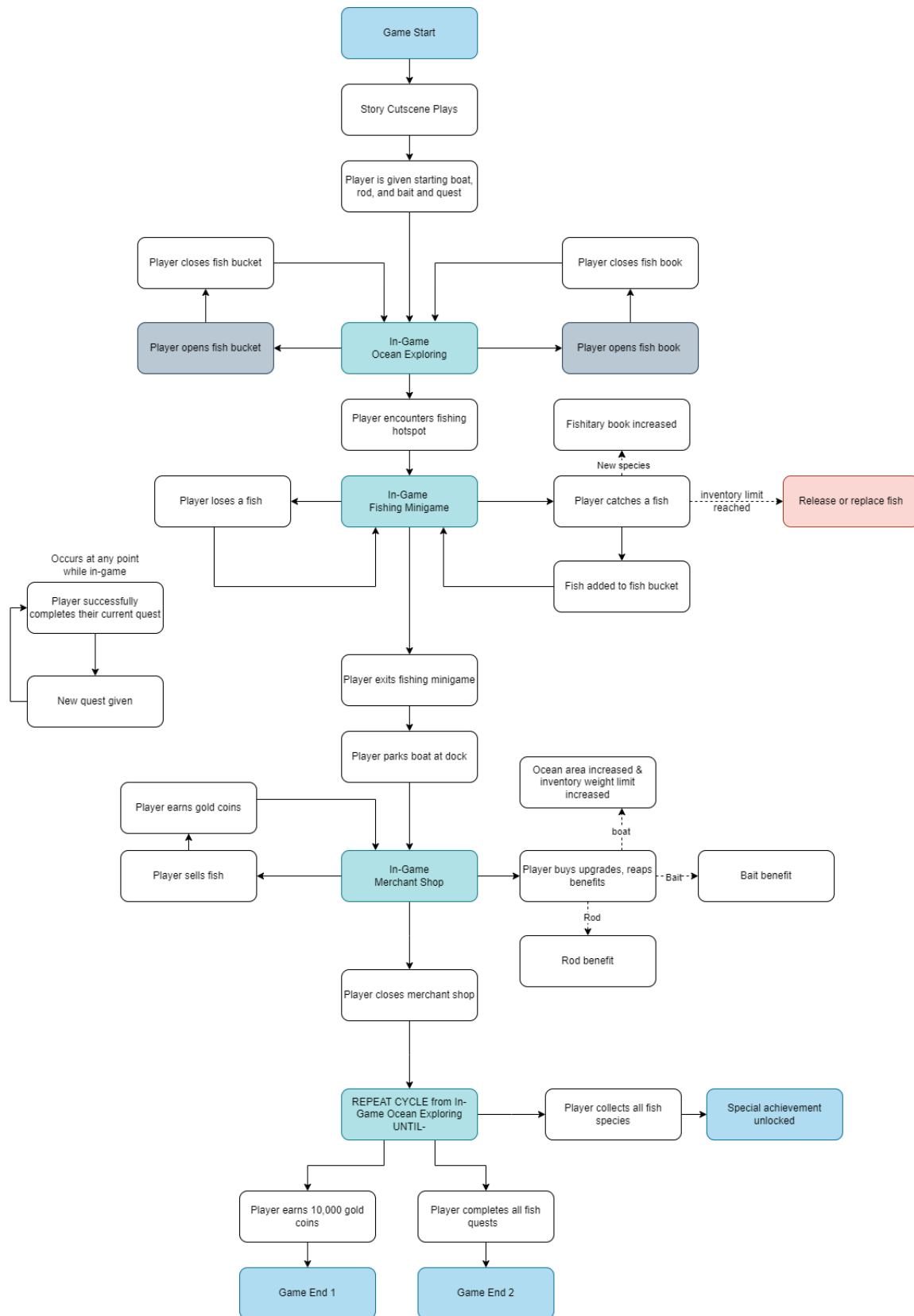
Fishbook/Fishituary

Learn more about this island, its inhabitants and the island's fish.

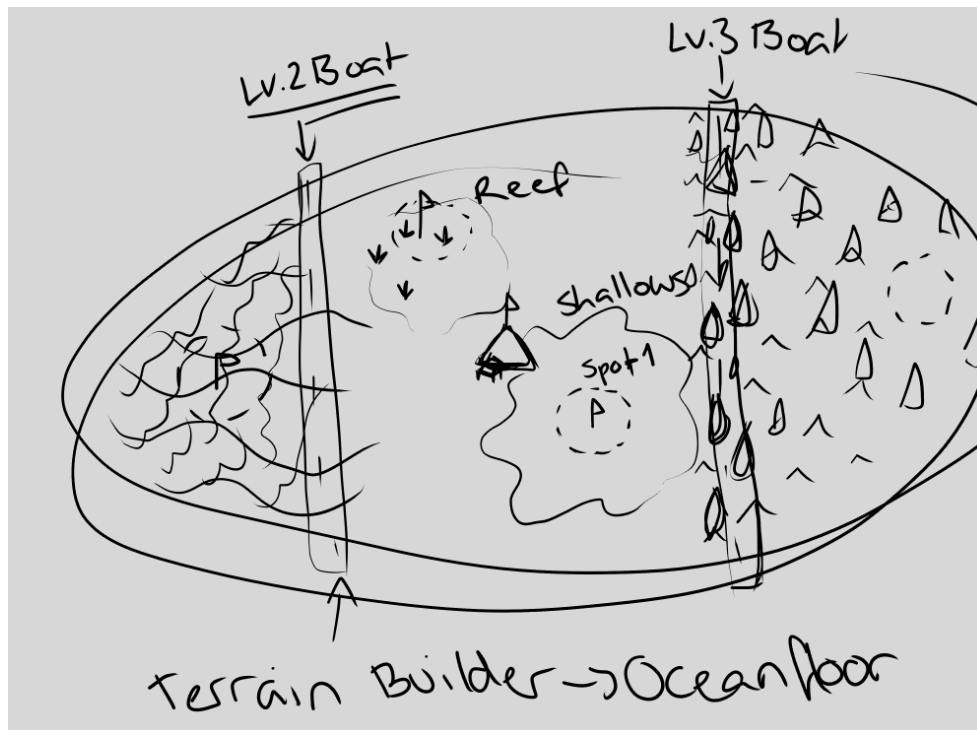
Strive to find all 20 fish species and fill out your fish collection, and unlock a new Fishituary page every time you find a new species of fish.

Gameplay Flow

Flowchart by Naomi



Level Design



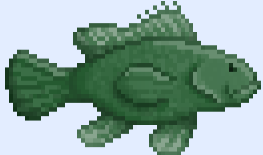
Concept by Milla

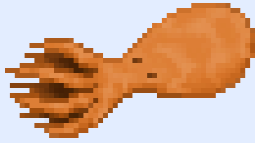
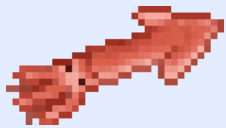
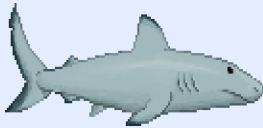
Mechanics

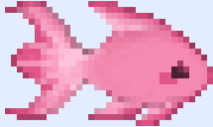
Fishing Minigame

Fish Types (19 Total)

Fish Art by Milla

Image	Name	Flavour Text	Information
	Sea Bass	"No wait- it's at least a C+!"	→ \$10 → Level 1/2 → 10kg → Shallow/Middle → Solo

	Clown Fish	<i>"Don't laugh, this clownfish is no joke, just look at that menacing face."</i>	- \$7 - Level 1 - 1kg - Shallow - Small Flocking
	Octopus	<i>"With its long 8 legs you should be afraid. It is a strong beast and can take your hook easily."</i>	- \$15 - Level 2 - 8kg - Middle - Solo
	Squid	<i>"It's like the one game with the kids and the squids"</i>	- \$8 - Level 1/2 - 5kg - Middle/Deep - Large Flocking
	Shark	<i>"The devil of the sea. You catch this and you should consider yourself the king of the fish."</i>	- \$50 - Level 3 - 100kg - Deep - Solo
	Smol Fish	<i>"Small little thing, but don't be fooled- it is hard to catch with its good manoeuvring."</i>	- \$5 - Level 1/2 - 0.5kg - Shallow/Middle - Large flocking
	Skeleton Fish	<i>"Once lived a happy life before perishing at the hands of a nasty fisherman; now its skeleton haunts these waters."</i>	- \$20 - Level 1/2 - 1kg - Deep - Small flocking
	Boring Fish	<i>"Why'd you catch this, it's boring?"</i>	- \$18 - Level 2 - 7kg - Middle - Solo
	Christmas Fish	<i>"I hear jingle bells"</i>	- \$25 - Level 3 - 10kg - Middle - Solo

	Seahorse	<i>"There must be something in the water because seahorses usually don't move THIS fast"</i>	- \$10 - Level 3 - 2kg - Shallow/Middle - Small Flocking
	Pufferfish	<i>"Haha poof"</i>	- \$15 - Level 2 - 5kg - Middle - Solo
	Eel	<i>"Dragons hate them"</i>	- \$12 - Level 2 - 8kg - Middle/Deep - Solo
	Pink Fish	<i>"Pink"</i>	- \$25 - Level 3 - 10kg - Shallow/Middle - Solo
	Basic Fish	<i>"The most basic fish of them all with not much too it."</i>	- \$5 - Level 1 - 5kg - All Depths - Small Flocking
	Angler Fish	<i>"If you ever need help with your maths, he's your guy"</i>	- \$30 - Level 3 - 30kg - Deep - Solo
	Sardine	<i>"You can tuna can but you can't tu- Wait wrong fish"</i>	- \$3 - Level 1/2 - 1kg - Shallow/Middle - Large Flocking

	Jellyfish	<i>"Mesmerising"</i>	- \$15 - Level 3 - 10kg - Middle/Deep - Small Flocking
	Moray Eel	<i>"Have you heard about their second mouth?"</i>	- \$15 - Level 3 - 25kg - Middle/Deep - Solo
	Dumb Fish	<i>"He's perfect in every way"</i>	- \$1 - Level 3 - 20kg - Deep - Solo

Fish Attributes

Each fish will have different attributes (Selling Price, Location Found, Weight, Depth, and Flocking Pattern) that are entirely unique to them.

Selling Price - How much that fish will sell for at the shop merchant.

Location Found - Which significant landmark or area on the map the fish can be found

Weight - How much the fish weighs in kilograms

Depth - At what depth in the fishing minigame, the fish can be found swimming

Flocking Pattern - What kind of flocking that species of fish has (whether a solo fish or a fish with a lot of other fish swimming with it in a group)

Fish Book (Fishituary)

Purpose: To give an easily accessible guide where players can find useful or interesting information about the characters, the island, the fish they catch and fish they have yet to catch. It's fun due to the worldbuilding nature of the book (giving little glimpses into what kind of world the player is in), and giving the player an overarching goal for the game (collecting every single species of fish, and satisfyingly completing their fish collection).

Behaviour: The Fish book, mechanically, is a popup UI screen, with a series of different menus attached to a corresponding tab that the player can click and switch between, much like a real book with tabs. Some information in this book will progressively change as the player progresses in the game (Fish silhouettes change to their proper fish image once the player has collected that fish species).

Dynamics: The player can use the book's map to identify different landmarks in the terrain to try and figure out where they are as they explore. They can use the book to find hints on the general locational whereabouts of the fish they haven't yet caught, and refer to the book to get an idea of how many fish species they still need to find. They can use the book to learn more about Johnny, the environment, and fish in the game, and see what kind of bait, boat and rod they currently have equipped.

Contents:

- ❖ Map Tab
 - *Two Info Pages about Sleepy Shores, art of the full view of the island, and significant landmarks.*
- ❖ Full View of Fish Collection Tab
 - *Two Pages covered in silhouettes of every single species of fish on the island (revealed once Player catches that fish)*
- ❖ Fishituary Tab
 - *20 Pages (one Page for each fish species, we have 20 fish species in total) and that the player can flip left and right through, with an image of the fish, flavour text description, weight, selling price, rarity/depth, and location it can be found.*

Shop Merchant

Purpose: To give value to the fish caught by Players, and the upgrades and gold coin count serve as a visual way to display the Player's current game progress, along with the perks that come along with it.

There will be one main upgrade in the form of boat upgrades. (stretch goal upgrades include bait upgrades, and fishing rod upgrades)

Boat Upgrade:

- Ability to upgrade your boat 2 times
- Changes the appearance of the boat each time (changes your default paddle boat to sailboat, then to motor boat)
- Increases your fish bucket weight limit

- Unlocks an area in the ocean (which contains more fishing spots with different fish to catch)

Ocean Exploration

Purpose: To give Players the freedom of choice; let them be able to seek and choose where they'd like to fish. And give them a sense of adventure; ability to explore this world's ocean fully in every nook and cranny.

User Interface

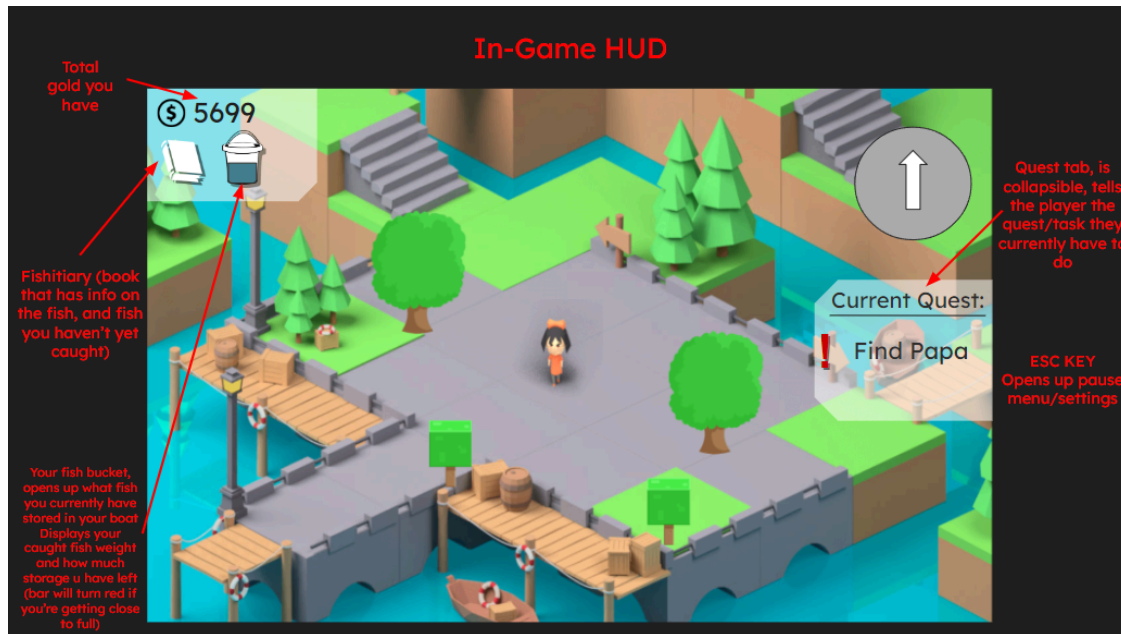
Overview

The User Interface (or UI) will visually maintain the pixel art style and aesthetic and will try its best to not break the immersion of the world and exploration within the game, while giving the player important progress info or game necessities.

GUI Elements

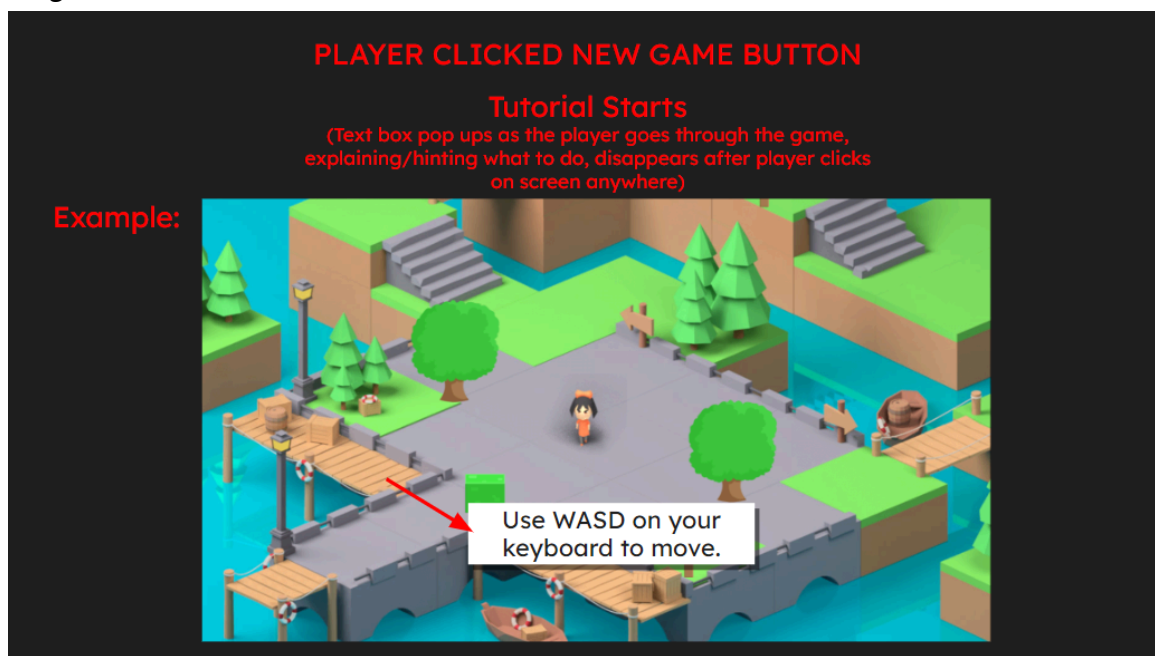
Heads Up Display (or HUD)

The In-Game HUD will display simple text containing information on how much gold they currently have and what quest is currently in progress, a Fish Bucket, and Fish Book Buttons which when hovered over will dim in colour to indicate that it is interactable, and a compass-like Arrow for ocean navigation. These will be updated as the Player progresses to display accurate and up-to-date information.



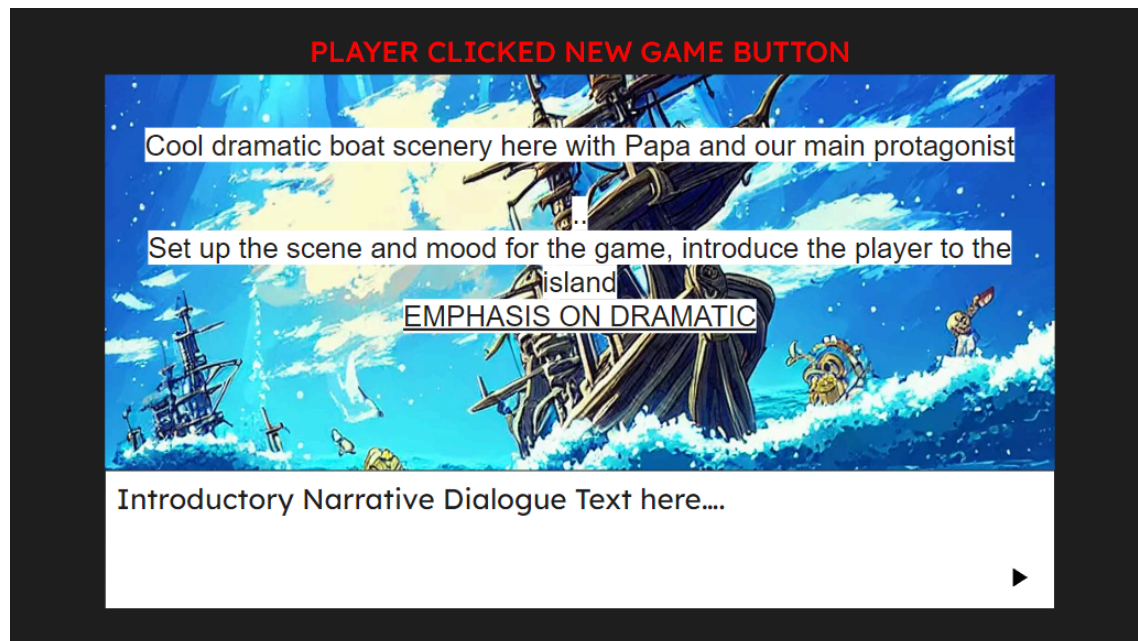
Tutorial Prompts (Stretch goal)

Tutorial prompts will appear in simple pixel art text boxes as the player explores the world and will give them guidance on the controls, what certain UI buttons do, and helpful hints to how to play the game.

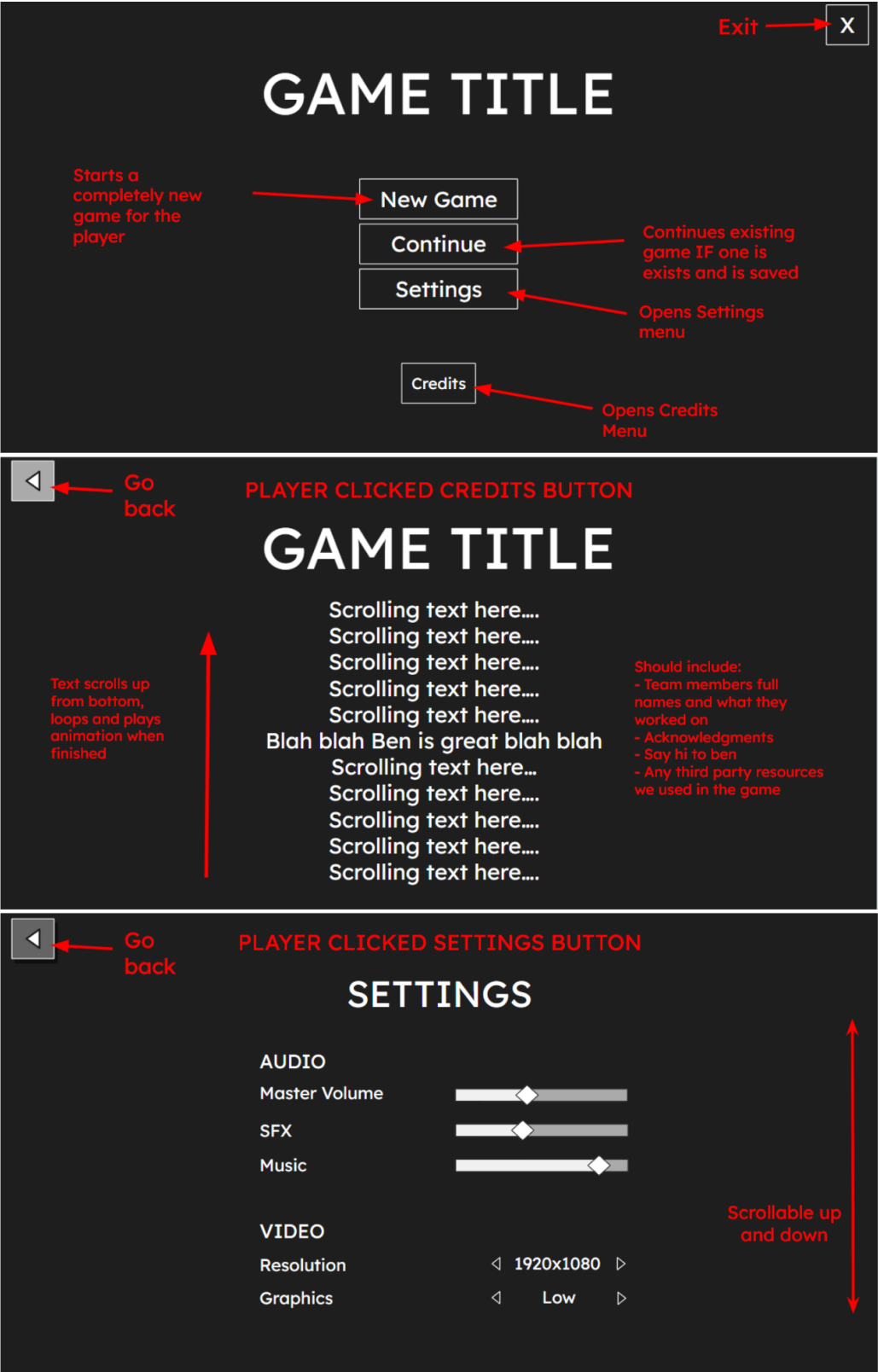


Story Cutscene & Dialogue (Stretch goal)

Story cutscene will display still art images relating to the dialogue text boxes underneath, which the Player can click or press any button to move forward and fade in the next series of story text or still image.

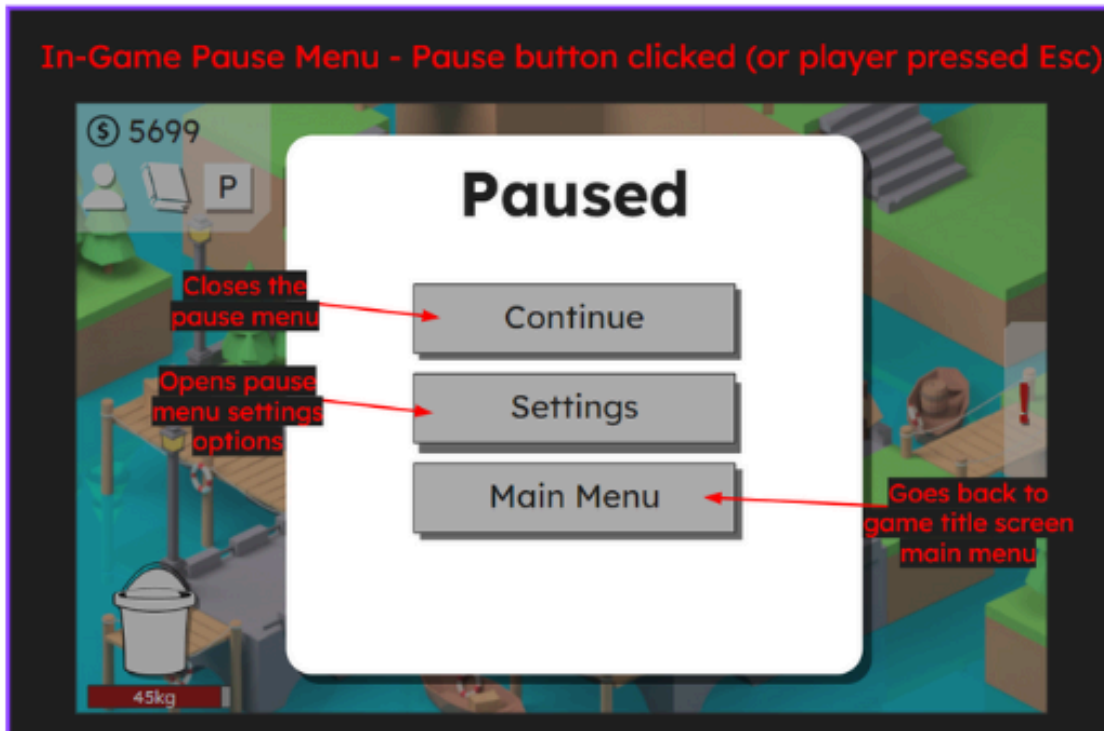


Title Screen Menu

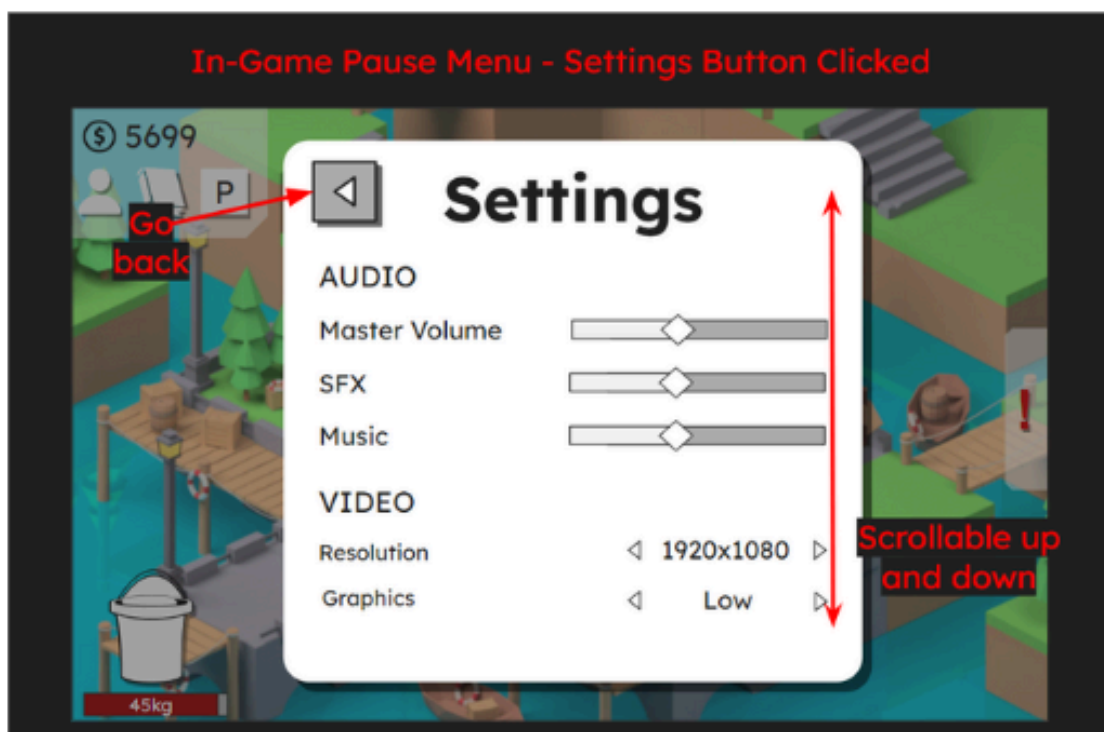


In-Game Pause Menu

In-Game Pause Menu - Pause button clicked (or player pressed Esc)



In-Game Pause Menu - Settings Button Clicked





Art Design

Overview

Sleepy Shores draws its art inspiration from both low poly stylized 3D art games like Dredge, and classic 2D pixel art games such as Stardew Valley, or Moonstone Island, creating a unique visual art style for the game in 2.5D, where the world environment will be explorable in low poly 3D while the characters, fish, fishing, and UI, will be 2D pixel art.

Art Specifications

Design	Stylised Low Poly 3D & Pixel Art 2D Hybrid
Poly Count	<5000 Tris Per Asset
Texture	Painted Solid Colour Flat Textures
2D Asset Dimensions	Something x something
3D Asset Size	Scale to 1 metre blocks, realistic sizing

Artistic Direction

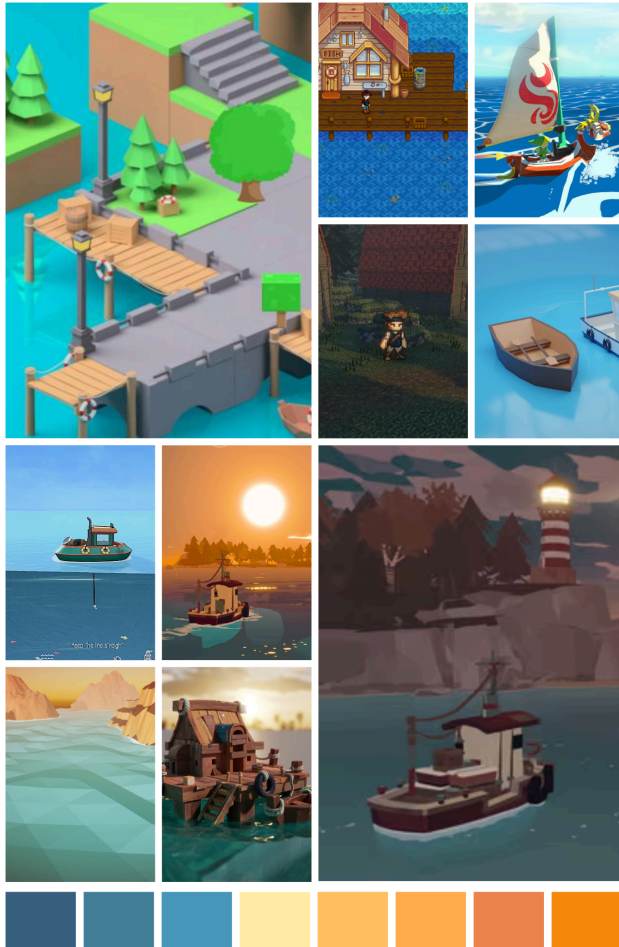
Sleepy Shores will have a warm summer time by the seaside ocean aesthetic, set in sunset time and lighting.

Art Inspirations

- ❖ Dredge
- ❖ Stardew Valley
- ❖ Ninja Fishing
- ❖ Sea of Stars

- ❖ Eiyuden Chronicle
- ❖ Boat tutorial from previous assignment

Art Style Moodboard



UI Art Style Moodboard



Audio in our game will communicate a sense of comfort and calm that will emit a relaxing seaside atmosphere for the player to immerse themselves in while playing.

Music

There will be background music within our game while they sail the ocean waters, this music should:

- ❖ *Be chill, upbeat and happy (but not obnoxiously), and somewhat smooth*
- ❖ *Contain a lot of exotic and tropical sounding instruments (such as guitar, strings, accordion, bongos, marimba etc) and have a good steady beat that players can bop their head to*
- ❖ *Give off the vibe that this is something you'd hear while sitting next to the docks or strolling along the boardwalk, or if you were on a high seas tropical island adventure, can be a little 8-bit ish due to our pixel art theme*
- ❖ *Catchy*
- ❖ *Music that can repeated over and over and not get annoying to listen to*

Music Inspirations

- ❖ *Real Fishing 3 - Shallow & Ultimate Angler/Streetpass Fishing - Let's go fishing*
[▶ gone fishing | relaxing video game music playlist](#)
- ❖ *Cat Goes Fishing - Main Theme* [▶ Music from Cat Goes Fishing](#)
- ❖ *Balkan Gypsy Folk Music* [▶ Slavic, Balkan and Gypsy Music](#)

SFX

There will be SFX in the form of UI interaction, NPC noises, and environmental sfx, which will give the Player important information through audio cues as well as the visual cues displayed.

UI Interaction SFX

- ❖ Fish book should have page flipping book sounds
- ❖ All other UI buttons should be natural and book-ish/real sounding, short & subtle, and should be fitting in the game environment and with our island ocean theme without breaking immersion.
- ❖ Selling and Buying SFX to sound like coins falling and typical cash register sounds.

NPC Noises

- ❖ All NPCs will have a distinct and unique voice and noises they make when talking to the player
- ❖ NPCs will not talk and instead make expressive sounds (such as grunts, snorts, or injections like *ahas*, *hmm*, *ohh* etc) based on the dialogue

Environmental SFX

- ❖ Boat will have SFX when moving, and when collision occurs
- ❖ Audio cues for Fishing Minigame to let the Player know audibly they've done something
- ❖ Ocean waves and relaxing seashore Ambience will be playing constantly in the background

SFX Inspirations

- ❖ *Fish Book SFX*  *Paper UI Sounds - V4.7*
- ❖ *Coins SFX*  *Coins falling sound effect*
- ❖ *Ocean Ambience*  *Free Island Beach Waves and Seagull sounds*



Development

Scope Overview

Sleepy Shores will consist of 8 main developers and 1 development supervisor, and will be in development for approximately 1 ¾ months (7 weeks), starting on the 21st of November 2023 and finishing on the 18th of January 2024.

Team Members

- ❖ Ben Anderson (*Producer & Supervisor*)
- ❖ Milla (*2D Art*)
- ❖ Camden (*Programming & UI*)
- ❖ Christiaan (*Programming & Sound*)
- ❖ Jerdine (*Writing/Flavour Text*)
- ❖ Naomi (*2D Art & UI*)
- ❖ Noah (*Programming, 3D Art*)
- ❖ Oliver (*Programming*)
- ❖ Susan (*Level Design*)

Risks

Risk Description	Severity	Likelihood	Mitigation Strategy
Overriding each other's work on github and unity	High	Probable	PUSH to git as regularly as possible. Don't work on the same scripts as one another
Burnout	Medium	Probable	Take breaks when necessary - Don't overwork yourself!
Communication Issues - large team, meaning potential difficulties communicating across the whole team efficiently/miscommunications or conflict	Medium	Very Likely	Regular team check-ins with the whole team and checking in with individuals. Implement communication ground rules for our team so we demonstrate mutual respect towards each other.
Overscoping- Getting too ambitious with the game we want to create with the time we have	Medium	Very likely	Plan ahead, make good use of the time we have separately and when we're working together to make sure we get the things we need to get done, done. Look over the time we have and try to think realistically what we are able to achieve with the skills, tools and time we have, don't forget to factor in our outside lives as well.

Testing Schedule

Project Stretch Goals

- ❖ Audio
- ❖ Animation
- ❖ Quest NPCs
- ❖ Fish Quests

- ❖ Fleshed out main story and characters
- ❖ Fishing line breaking
- ❖ Quality of life additions
- ❖ Save and load files
- ❖ Intro story cutscene
- ❖ Tutorial prompts
- ❖ Player customisation
- ❖ Bait and rod upgrades

All other aspects of our game will take priority over these within development.

Useful Resources for our Project

 Fishing Game Third Party Resources/Credits to give

 Untitled presentation

[Jira Task Managing](#)

[Testing Feedback Form](#)

 Contribution Document

Collaboration Tools

Jira - *Task Management*

Discord - *Communication, Discussions & Information Storing/Sharing*

Zoom - *Communication*

Microsoft Teams - *Communication & Information Sharing*

Fin :)